

Vibe Appliance — Multi-Box Firms

Several servers, one Sentinel: connecting every box and workstation to the firm's monitoring.

Vibe Appliance setup guide · built 2026-08-31 · facts from the vibe-sentinel-installer docs and lib/sentinel-enroll.sh · KisaesDevLab/Vibe-Appliance

1. The shape of a multi-box firm

Some firms outgrow one server: an appliance box (or several) running the accounting apps, and a separate box running **Vibe Sentinel** — the security-monitoring and compliance stack, which wants its own hardware (4 cores / 8 GB free for its core alone). This guide covers the part that trips people up: connecting the other machines to Sentinel so it actually watches them.

Two layers connect every machine, always in this order:

1. **The mesh (NetBird).** A private WireGuard network between the firm's machines. Every Sentinel service listens only on the mesh interface.
2. **The monitoring agent (Wazuh).** Installed on each machine, reporting to the Sentinel box over the mesh.

2. "But my boxes are on the same network — do I need the mesh?"

Yes — and not because of routing. Three reasons, and one reassurance:

- **Sentinel doesn't listen on your LAN, on purpose.** Its services bind the mesh interface only. An office LAN has printers, phones, guest Wi-Fi, and whatever a visitor plugged in; "on the LAN" is not an identity.
- **The mesh is the identity layer.** A mesh peer enrolled with a one-time key is a known machine with its own cryptographic identity — that is what the monitoring evidence hangs off.
- **It's the encryption layer, and it travels.** Agent traffic is encrypted end-to-end (WireGuard), and the same enrollment keeps working when a laptop goes home for the weekend.
- **The reassurance:** two mesh peers on the same LAN connect directly to each other — no relay, no round-trip through the internet. On one network the mesh costs approximately nothing and you keep all three properties above.

A firm that already runs an equivalent overlay (Tailscale, for example) can leave Sentinel's mesh module off — that is a Security Six control, so the installer records the compensating control you name. That's the sanctioned path; binding Sentinel's services to the bare LAN is not.

3. Connect another appliance box (from its own console)

On each additional appliance/app box, the admin console does this for you:

1. **On the Sentinel box**, generate enrollment credentials:

```
sudo bash /opt/vibe-sentinel-installer/lite/generate-lite.sh --platform linux --role docker-host
```

The output includes the four values the next step asks for: the NetBird management URL, a **one-time setup key** (single-use, expires in 48 hours — generate it when you're ready), the Wazuh manager's mesh hostname, and the agent-enrollment password.

2. **On the app box's console:** Apps → the Security & Compliance section → **Connect this box to the firm's Sentinel...** Paste the four values, pick the role (`docker-host` for an appliance), click Connect. The box joins the mesh first, health-checks it, then installs and enrolls the agent — the transcript streams into the page, and every failure names the step and the fix. Re-running is safe; it converges.
3. **Verify:** the box's Host services panel shows Sentinel enrollment — enrolled, and the machine appears in the Wazuh dashboard on the Sentinel box within a couple of minutes.

4. Connect workstations and other machines

Staff computers use the same generator with per-platform bundles:

```
sudo bash /opt/vibe-sentinel-installer/lite/generate-lite.sh --platform all --role workstation
```

That produces Windows, macOS, and Linux bundles under `/var/lib/vibe-sentinel/lite/<timestamp>/`, each carrying the mesh client with its one-time key, the preconfigured agent, the audit rules for its platform, and a posture collector — run the bundle on the machine and it enrolls itself, mesh first, refusing to continue if the mesh doesn't come up. Bundles contain credentials: move them on encrypted media or over the mesh, never by email, and delete them once the batch is enrolled. One key per machine.

5. What else connects across boxes

- **Uptime monitoring:** Sentinel's pulse module (Uptime Kuma) can probe each appliance box's `/health` endpoints across the mesh — add the monitors in Sentinel's own UI.
- **One print gateway, firm-wide:** Vibe Print and Sentinel's print module are the same product (the cards say so). In a multi-box firm, run Sentinel's copy and leave the appliance boxes' copies disabled — the apps reach it over the mesh, and one gateway means one job history and one audit log.

- **The catalogs link up:** each appliance console lists the Sentinel modules and links to the Sentinel host's UI once it answers on the firm domain — one place to see the estate from any box.

6. If something goes wrong

- **Mesh joined but the agent won't confirm:** almost always the wrong manager hostname, a wrong enrollment password, or 1514/1515 closed on the Sentinel host's mesh interface. The Connect transcript's last step says which; fix and re-run — it converges.
- **"Setup key rejected":** keys are one-time and short-lived by design. Generate a fresh one on the Sentinel box and try again.
- **A box stops reporting:** check its Host services panel (Sentinel enrollment row), then `sudo netbird status` and `sudo systemctl status wazuh-agent` on that box. The Sentinel side alerts on silent agents — that is its job.